

A One-Loop BV Obstruction in Pure Weyl Gravity and Its Formal τ -adic Wess–Zumino Resolution

Asger Alstrup Palm*

Working draft, July 2026

Abstract

We compute the coefficient-bearing one-loop BV anomaly of strict four- dimensional pure Weyl gravity in the complete local gauge-fixed quotient on the declared regular Bach-locus chart. The repository Euclidean elliptic complex, measure, zero-mode, contour, parity, and local heat-kernel ledgers give

$$\mathcal{A}^{(1)} = \frac{1}{(4\pi)^2} \left(\frac{199}{30} [\omega C^2] - \frac{87}{20} [\omega E_4] \right).$$

Both coordinates are nonzero in the strict quotient. Hence the fixed-field- content local Euclidean quantum master equation is obstructed at one loop. An exact dual-cone witness further excludes cancellation by any nonnegative combination of standard-sign free conformal scalars, Weyl or Dirac fermions, and gauge vectors.

We then adjoin a shifting scalar τ and derive its complete minimal-BV cotangent lift from $S_{\tau, \min} = \int \tau^* (\mathcal{L}_\xi \tau + \omega)$. In dressed canonical variables

$$\hat{g} = e^{-2\tau} g, \quad \hat{g}^* = e^{2\tau} g^*, \quad \hat{\tau}^* = \tau^* + 2g_{\mu\nu} g^{*\mu\nu},$$

the Weyl sector is an exact contractible quartet. In the formal τ -adic local analytic jet algebra the complete dimension-four extended quotient is

$$\dim H_{\text{ext}}^{0,4} = (3 \text{ even}, 1 \text{ odd}), \quad H_{\text{ext}}^{1,4} = 0.$$

The coefficient-bearing Wess–Zumino counterterm therefore restores the extended local Euclidean QME at one loop.

The two dispositions refer to different theories and are not contradictory: strict field content is obstructed, while the formal τ -adic compensator extension is locally restored at one loop. Neither statement is an all-loop or Lorentzian QME theorem.

AI-use disclosure and computational accountability

OpenAI GPT-5 was used substantively for mathematical synthesis, verification code, claim auditing, and manuscript drafting. The human author directed the programme and remains responsible for the claims, citations, and final text. All cohomological ranks and cancellations reported here use exact rational arithmetic. Every headline statement is bound to a deterministic certificate and an independent verifier. Submission remains conditional on final human and literature review.

*Corresponding author: asger@area9.dk.

Contents

1	Question, result, and claim boundary	2
2	Strict local BV obstruction space	2
3	Coefficient-bearing one-loop breaking	4
4	The compensator cotangent lift	6
5	Extended cohomology and QME restoration	6
6	Consequences for one-loop effective-action representatives	8
7	What does not follow	10
8	Machine certification and reproduction	10
9	Outlook	12

1 Question, result, and claim boundary

Pure Weyl gravity has classical $\text{Diff} \times \text{Weyl}$ gauge symmetry. The quantum question is not whether a determinant has a nonzero logarithm, but whether the regularized Slavnov breaking is trivial in the relative BV cohomology $H^{1,4}(s \mid d)$. We therefore separate three calculations:

1. classify the complete local obstruction space;
2. compute the coefficient vector in one specified analytic route;
3. decide whether that vector is a boundary in the chosen field theory.

The result has two theory labels which must not be suppressed:

Theory	One-loop local Euclidean disposition
strict pure Weyl gravity, fixed field content	obstructed
formal τ -adic Wess–Zumino compensator extension	QME restored

The second row does not reverse the first. It changes the BV complex.

All local results carry LOCAL-ALGEBRAIC; the coefficient computation also carries EUCLIDEAN-SPECTRAL. No result in this paper carries LORENTZIAN-CAUSAL.

2 Strict local BV obstruction space

The local jet algebra tracks ghost number, antifield number, form degree, engineering dimension, Grassmann parity, spacetime parity, and Weyl weight. Tensor symmetries, algebraic and differential Bianchi identities, graded commutativity, dummy-index relabelling, integration by parts, and total derivatives are reduced before exact sparse linear algebra is performed.

On the regular Bach-locus chart, the minimal Koszul–Tate sector contracts at positive antifield number. Ten nonminimal pairs contract explicitly, and an arbitrary invertible local BV-canonical gauge-fixing transformation preserves the quotient. The pure-diffeomorphism and mixed Diff–Weyl total complexes add no independent four-dimensional anomaly class.

Theorem 2.1 (Strict dimension-four anomaly quotient on the regular Bach locus). *In the declared complete gauge-fixed local BV complex on a regular Bach-locus chart,*

$$\dim H_{\text{even}}^{1,4}(s \mid d) = 2, \quad \dim H_{\text{odd}}^{1,4}(s \mid d) = 1.$$

Representatives may be chosen as

$$[\omega C^2], \quad [\omega E_4], \quad [\omega C\tilde{C}].$$

The type-D carrier $\omega \square R$ is exact with its stored R^2 counterterm and horizontal current.

The qualifier is load-bearing. In adapted jet coordinates the Bach Euler row and its differential consequences replace the transverse-tracefree highest metric jets. Rank-changing strata with additional reducibility or Killing data are not covered by this chart theorem.

The proof is an antifield-number spectral sequence rather than a list of familiar densities, following the local antifield-BRST architecture of Barnich, Brandt, and Henneaux [3]. Its exact steps are:

1. At E_0 , the Koszul–Tate differential contracts the six adapted pairs (g^*, E_g) , (ξ^*, N_ξ) , (ω^*, N_ω) and their Lie-prolonged partners. Hence every positive-antifield column vanishes on the regular chart.
2. At E_1 , the longitudinal differential reduces the antifield-zero sector to $\text{Diff} \times \text{Weyl}$ invariant jets. The forward tensor-graph enumerator and reverse signature coverage agree under the dimension-four bound.
3. Relative d-cohomology and the total descent complex leave two even Weyl-ghost classes and one odd class. The pure-Diff and mixed total-complex blocks have zero quotient.
4. Ten pointwise nonminimal pairs contract, and the contraction transports through any invertible local BV-canonical gauge-fixing map. Therefore the minimal, nonminimal, and gauge-fixed quotients are chain-isomorphic.

The spectral sequence collapses at E_2 . In the type-D row the stored primitive is normalized by the explicit identity

$$\int \sqrt{g} \omega \square R = -\frac{1}{12} s \int \sqrt{g} R^2 \pmod{d}.$$

The full ranks and pair counts appear in the generated spectral-sequence table of the computational supplement.

Closure, exact primitives, complete basis manifests, and normalized dual nonmembership witnesses are stored independently. The universal diffeomorphism descent and intrinsic Weyl descent are recorded separately; in particular, a nonzero Diff-horizontal tower is not called a nontrivial intrinsic Weyl descent.

This separation matches the algebraic Weyl-anomaly classification of Boulanger [4]: the Euler/type-A class is distinguished by a nontrivial intrinsic Weyl descent, whereas strictly Weyl-invariant type-B densities have trivial intrinsic Weyl descent. The present calculation has a different target and scope. It retains the universal Diff completion, the dynamical metric antifields, the Koszul–Tate filtration, and the explicit minimal-to-gauge-fixed BV comparison needed for the pure-gravity master equation.

3 Coefficient-bearing one-loop breaking

The coefficient route combines two independent curvature carriers. A local Ricci-flat carrier exposes C^2 , while round S^4 fixes the Euler coordinate. The first five-dimensional bundle in the Euclidean symbol sequence is the gauge-parameter bundle $T \oplus \mathbf{1}$ (four Diff directions plus one Weyl direction), the ten-dimensional middle bundle is $S^2 T^*$, and the final five-dimensional bundle is the transverse-tracefree symbol slice. Thus

$$(T \oplus \mathbf{1})_5 \xrightarrow{\sigma(K)} (S^2 T^*)_{10} \xrightarrow{\sigma(P_{\text{TT}})} (S_{\text{TT}}^2 T^*)_5, \quad \text{im } \sigma(K) = \ker \sigma(P_{\text{TT}}).$$

The separate $5 \leftarrow 10 \leftarrow 5$ sequence is its cotangent formal adjoint; the endpoint is not being identified with the unreduced ten-component Bach equation. Determinant multiplicities, the functional measure, conformal-Killing zero modes, the factorwise spectral cut, the locally constant negative-scalar phase, and the parity Ward identity are included in the accepted integration slice.

The complete local determinant ledger is small enough to display:

sector	operator	rank	statistics	Z exponent	zero modes	local prescription
metric TT, upper	$\Delta_{2,\perp}(4)$	5	bosonic	$-1/2$	0	factorwise cut
Diff-Weyl scalar ghost	$\Delta_0(-4)'$	1	fermionic	$+1/2$	5	cut; negative-mode phase locally constant
metric TT, lower	$\Delta_{2,\perp}(2)$	5	bosonic	$-1/2$	0	factorwise cut
transverse Diff ghost	$\Delta_{1,\perp}(-3)'$	3	fermionic	$+1/2$	10	factorwise cut

All four factors use the same factorwise zeta/heat-kernel spectral cut. The single negative scalar phase is locally constant on the fixed stabilizer stratum and therefore drops out of the local b_4 variation; its global phase is not claimed. The primes remove precisely the fifteen conformal-Killing ghost modes. York/Hodge Jacobians and the ten nonminimal doublets have already been included before the four displayed factors are formed.

To make the determinant-to-BV bridge explicit, let σ denote a bosonic Weyl parameter. Dimensional regularization first gives the local supertrace

$$\Gamma_{\text{div}}^{(1)}(d) = \frac{\mu^{d-4}}{(4\pi)^2(d-4)} \int \sqrt{g} [cC^2 - aE_4 + b\Box R + \text{BRST-exact rows}].$$

The regulated Ward insertion is not inferred from this scalar functional by name matching. It is computed as

$$\mathcal{S}_S \Gamma_{\text{reg}}^{(1)} = \lim_{d \rightarrow 4} s_d \Gamma_{\text{div}}^{(1)}(d),$$

where the $(d-4)$ Weyl variation of the dimensionally continued densities cancels the pole. Replacing σ by the Weyl ghost ω , adding the certified universal Diff completion, and reducing the exact, gauge-dependent, and total-derivative rows against the complete gauge-fixed $H^{1,4}(s \mid d)$ gives

$$\mathcal{S}_S \Gamma_{\text{reg}}^{(1)} = \frac{1}{(4\pi)^2} \int \sqrt{g} \omega (cC^2 - aE_4 + b\Box R) + s\mathcal{B} + d\mathcal{C}.$$

This is the coefficient-bearing map from the Euclidean integration slice to a ghost-number-one Slavnov class; it is why a logarithmic divergence, trace anomaly, and BV anomaly are not silently conflated.

Theorem 3.1 (Repository one-loop Slavnov breaking). *In the normalization*

$$S_W = \alpha_C \int \sqrt{g} C^2,$$

the repository-regulated breaking has coordinates

$$(C^2, E_4, C\tilde{C}, \square R) = \left(\frac{199}{30}, -\frac{87}{20}, 0, 0 \right).$$

After reduction against the complete strict quotient,

$$\mathcal{A}^{(1)} = \frac{1}{(4\pi)^2} \left(\frac{199}{30} [\omega C^2] - \frac{87}{20} [\omega E_4] \right).$$

Consequently the strict fixed-field-content local Euclidean QME is obstructed at one loop.

The odd zero is derived from the parity Ward identity for the declared real tensor-Laplacian regulator. The type-D zero is scheme-dependent but exact; it cannot cancel either nontrivial coordinate. A beta function alone would not prove this theorem: the decisive object is the regulated Slavnov breaking reduced in the complete BV quotient.

The even numbers agree, after translating the Euler-sign convention, with the classic one-loop Weyl-gravity anomaly of Fradkin and Tseytlin [5]. Our claim is not that these constants were previously unknown. It is the content-addressed identification of the repository elliptic complex, multiplicities, measure, zero modes, contour, and regulator with a complete BV obstruction basis, followed by the explicit Slavnov-class disposition. The local $\square R$ term has a separate scheme-sensitive history; the recent heat-kernel analysis of Barvinsky et al. [7] makes that distinction explicit. In the scheme frozen here its coefficient is zero and the class is in any case removed by the stored R^2 primitive.

Proposition 3.2 (Standard unitary free matter cannot cancel the vector). *Let the added matter content be any nonnegative combination of real conformal scalars, Weyl or Dirac fermions, and standard gauge vectors. No such combination cancels both even coordinates of the strict breaking.*

These are free, massless spectator fields conformally coupled to the same metric; gauge vectors include their standard BRST ghosts. In the convention $(c, -a)$ their exact vectors are

field	c	$-a$
pure Weyl graviton	199/30	-87/20
real conformal scalar	1/120	-1/360
Weyl fermion	1/40	-11/720
Dirac fermion	1/20	-11/360
gauge vector	1/10	-31/180

The separating functional is simply $\ell(c, -a) = c$: it is strictly positive on the gravity vector and on every allowed matter ray. Hence no nonnegative real combination, and a fortiori no nonnegative integer field content, can reach the origin. Interacting fixed points, wrong-sign or nonunitary matter, conformal higher spins, and compensator extensions lie outside this no-go.

4 The compensator cotangent lift

Adjoin a scalar with BRST transformation

$$Q\tau = \mathcal{L}_\xi \tau + \omega.$$

Its cotangent rows are not guessed. They are the Euler derivatives of the single minimal master term

$$S_{\tau, \min} = \int \tau^* (\mathcal{L}_\xi \tau + \omega).$$

In addition to the field row this forces

$$\delta\omega^* = 2g_{\mu\nu}g^{*\mu\nu} + \tau^*, \quad \delta\xi_\mu^* = N_{\xi, \mu} + \tau^* \nabla_\mu \tau, \quad \gamma\tau^* = \mathcal{L}_\xi \tau^*,$$

together with the opposite-adjoint Lie-prolonged rows.

Theorem 4.1 (Exact minimal-BV cotangent lift). *On every strict-plus-compensator generator and covariant jet generator,*

$$\delta^2 = 0, \quad \delta\gamma + \gamma\delta = 0, \quad Q^2 = 0.$$

The canonical change

$$\hat{g} = e^{-2\tau} g, \quad \hat{g}^* = e^{2\tau} g^*, \quad \hat{\tau}^* = \tau^* + 2g_{\mu\nu}g^{*\mu\nu}$$

preserves the canonical one-form and sends the Weyl Koszul–Tate row to $\delta\omega^ = \hat{\tau}^*$. Thus $(\tau, \omega, \omega^*, \hat{\tau}^*)$ is an exact contractible quartet.*

In the ordered basis $(\tau, \omega, \omega^*, \hat{\tau}^*)$, the Weyl part of the differential and its homotopy act by

$$Q_W \tau = \omega, \quad Q_W \omega^* = \hat{\tau}^*, \quad h\omega = \tau, \quad h\hat{\tau}^* = \omega^*,$$

and vanish on the other two basis generators. Consequently

$$Q_W h + h Q_W = N_{\text{quartet}}.$$

On a monomial of positive quartet number the contracting homotopy is $N_{\text{quartet}}^{-1} h$, extended to covariant jets as a graded derivation. The Diff and horizontal pieces preserve quartet number, so the filtered total-complex contraction follows by homological perturbation in the declared formal completion.

The exponential change is an automorphism only after declaring the formal τ -adic local analytic completion. Its two inverse series are replayed with exact rational coefficients and obey at every order

$$\sum_{k=0}^n \frac{(-2)^k}{k!} \frac{2^{n-k}}{(n-k)!} = \frac{2^n}{n!} (1-1)^n = \delta_{n0}.$$

No finite-polynomial-in- τ theorem is inferred.

5 Extended cohomology and QME restoration

Quartet contraction reduces the extended complex to pure Diff BV cohomology in the dressed metric $\hat{g}$. The dimension-four counterterm inventory is therefore larger than in strict Weyl gravity: $R(\hat{g})^2$ is now closed. The declared algebra is the formal τ -adic local analytic jet completion generated by $\hat{g}$, its cotangent variables, Diff ghosts, the quartet, curvatures and covariant derivatives, with the

same dimension and form-degree bounds as the strict calculation. The canonical dressed change is invertible in this completion. After quartet contraction, forward invariant generation and reverse grading-signature coverage leave precisely the pure-Diff dimension-four metric invariants below; the independently completed pure-Diff ghost-one total complex has zero quotient. Nonminimal and gauge-fixing transport then preserve that result. Thus the vanishing assertion is a complete statement in this declared formal algebra, not an AFN0 primitive test alone.

Theorem 5.1 (Formal τ -adic extended quotient). *In the declared formal τ -adic local analytic jet algebra on the regular Bach locus,*

$$H_{\text{ext,even}}^{0,4} = \text{span}\{C(\widehat{g})^2, E_4(\widehat{g}), R(\widehat{g})^2\},$$

$$H_{\text{ext,odd}}^{0,4} = \text{span}\{C(\widehat{g})\widetilde{C}(\widehat{g})\}, \quad H_{\text{ext}}^{1,4} = 0.$$

$\square R(\widehat{g})$ remains horizontally exact. There is no incoming dimension-four positive-antifield boundary: the only dimension-zero natural symmetric tensor is $\widehat{g}$, whose image is the vanishing trace of the Bach row.

Explicit primitives for the strict four-candidate anomaly carrier are

$$B_C = \int \sqrt{g} \tau C^2, \quad B_P = \int \sqrt{g} \tau C \widetilde{C},$$

and the Euler Wess–Zumino functional is

$$B_E = \int \sqrt{g} [\tau E_4 + 4G^{\mu\nu} \nabla_\mu \tau \nabla_\nu \tau - 4(\square \tau)(\nabla \tau)^2 + 2(\nabla \tau)^4].$$

With the conventions above,

$$s_{\text{ext}} B_E = \int \sqrt{g} \omega E_4 \pmod{\mathfrak{d}}.$$

The termwise intrinsic Euler descent and its universal Diff completion are stored separately. Together with the R^2 primitive $B_\square$, these four primitives have an exact rank-four boundary matrix. The curved-background Euler primitive agrees with the standard dilaton Wess–Zumino construction obtained from finite Weyl transformation of dimensionally regulated counterterms [6]. The new certificate needed here is not the displayed AFN0 formula alone: it is the cotangent lift, quartet contraction, exhaustive extended $H^{0,4}/H^{1,4}$ comparison, and coefficient-bearing BV boundary equation.

This restoration has a physical price. The compensator theory is not quantum-equivalent to strict Weyl gravity: gauge fixing $\tau = 0$ does not turn the anomalous strict quotient into an anomaly-free theory, while the dressed Diff theory permits counterterms such as $R(\widehat{g})^2$ and finite normalizations unavailable in the strict quotient. Exactness is obtained by enlarging both the BV complex and its local counterterm algebra.

Corollary 5.2 (One-loop local Euclidean QME restoration). *The counterterm*

$$-\frac{\hbar}{(4\pi)^2} \left(\frac{199}{30} B_C - \frac{87}{20} B_E \right)$$

satisfies

$$\mathcal{A}^{(1)} + s_{\text{ext}} S_{\text{ct}}^{(1)} = 0 \pmod{\mathfrak{d}}.$$

Hence the compensator-extended local Euclidean QME is restored at one loop in the declared formal τ -adic algebra.

Proposition 5.3 (The restored QME does not determine a unique Q_1). *Define the coefficient-bearing one-loop Wess–Zumino functional by*

$$C_1^{\text{WZ}} = -\frac{1}{(4\pi)^2} \left(\frac{199}{30} B_C - \frac{87}{20} B_E \right).$$

The local Wess–Zumino Hamiltonian contribution

$$Q_1^{\text{WZ}} = (C_1^{\text{WZ}}, \cdot)$$

is coefficient-bearing and fixed by the counterterm above. The complete renormalized first Slavnov operator is nevertheless underdetermined. On the dimensionless flat Euclidean fixture $p = (1, 0, 0, 0)$, in units of the chosen reference momentum, with $h_{11} = 1$, $h_{22} = -1$ and all other TT components zero, together with one conformal polarization, the bulk quadratic response of the allowed basis $(C(\hat{g})^2, E_4(\hat{g}), R(\hat{g})^2, C(\hat{g})\tilde{C}(\hat{g}))$ is

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 9 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Thus the C^2 and R^2 finite-counterterm directions change the bulk Hamiltonian vector field independently. This response calculation alone does not supply a nonlocal representative, the renormalized BV Laplacian or time-ordered product, or finite normalization conditions. The next proposition supplies the anomaly-induced nonlocal component, but not the Weyl-invariant finite remainder.

6 Consequences for one-loop effective-action representatives

Proposition 6.1 (Anomaly-induced Euclidean representative). *Set*

$$\mathcal{E}_4 = E_4 - \frac{2}{3} \square R, \quad \Delta_4 = \square^2 + 2R^{\mu\nu} \nabla_\mu \nabla_\nu - \frac{2}{3} R \square + \frac{1}{3} (\nabla^\mu R) \nabla_\mu.$$

This is the four-dimensional Paneitz operator [9]. On an invertible Euclidean boundary problem, or on the compatible source sector of a self-adjoint generalized inverse G_4 of Δ_4 , one anomaly-induced representative is

$$\Gamma_{1,\text{anom}} = \frac{1}{(4\pi)^2} \left\{ \frac{1}{8} \langle \mathcal{E}_4, G_4 (2cC^2 - a\mathcal{E}_4) \rangle + \frac{a}{18} \int \sqrt{g} R^2 \right\}, \quad (c, a) = \left(\frac{199}{30}, \frac{87}{20} \right).$$

Its Weyl variation is the certified anomaly $(4\pi)^{-2}(cC^2 - aE_4)$ in that sector. The three functional coefficients are

$$\left(\frac{199}{120}, -\frac{87}{160}, \frac{29}{120} \right).$$

The last coefficient follows from $\delta_\sigma \int \sqrt{g} R^2 = -12 \int \sqrt{g} \sigma \square R$ and is required to return from the canonical $\mathcal{E}_4$ representative to the repository $\square R = 0$ convention. This is the Riegert construction [8] with the scheme conversion made explicit; it is not the complete finite effective action.

Proposition 6.2 (Universal flat-TT logarithmic form factor). *On the positive nonzero-momentum flat Euclidean transverse-traceless carrier, the quadratic conformal-sector form factor is*

$$\Gamma_{1,\text{TT}}^{(2)} = \frac{1}{(4\pi)^2} \left\langle C^{(1)}, F_C(p^2; \mu) C^{(1)} \right\rangle, \quad F_C(p^2; \mu) = -\frac{199}{60} \log \frac{p^2}{\mu^2} + z_C(\mu).$$

The logarithmic coefficient obeys

$$-\frac{199}{60} = -\frac{c}{2} = -\frac{\beta_2}{4}, \quad (c, \beta_2) = \left(\frac{199}{30}, \frac{199}{15} \right),$$

and therefore

$$\mu \partial_\mu F_C = \frac{199}{30}, \quad F_C(p^2; \mu) - F_C(q^2; \mu) = -\frac{199}{60} \log \frac{p^2}{q^2}.$$

The factor of $1/2$ is fixed by the stated normalization: $\langle C^{(1)}, C^{(1)} \rangle = 1$ and $\mu \partial_\mu \log(p^2/\mu^2) = -2$, so matching the scale response c requires $-2A_{\log} = c$ and hence $A_{\log} = -c/2 = -199/60$. This fixes the universal scale-dependent part and the scheme-independent momentum difference. A reference condition $F_C(\kappa_{\text{ref}}^2; \mu) = N_C$ instead fixes the still-free local constant as

$$z_C(\mu) = N_C + \frac{199}{60} \log \frac{\kappa_{\text{ref}}^2}{\mu^2}.$$

The separation of anomaly-induced and conformal parts and the appearance of logarithmic non-local curvature form factors follow the covariant effective-action framework of Barvinsky and Wachowski [10]. The present certificate is restricted to the declared flat carrier. The next proposition supplies its curvature-squared covariantization, but neither result supplies the cubic completion, zero-momentum definition, Lorentzian branch prescription, or a particle state.

Proposition 6.3 (Endomorphism-class covariant logarithm through curvature order two). *Let Δ_C be a positive self-adjoint Laplace-type operator on the algebraic Weyl-tensor bundle, with a fixed self-adjoint elliptic domain, and let $\Pi_\perp$ project off its kernel. Covariant perturbation theory through total curvature order two gives*

$$\Gamma_{1, C^2 \log}^{(2)} = -\frac{1}{(4\pi)^2} \frac{199}{60} \left\langle C, \Pi_\perp \log \frac{\Delta_C}{\mu^2} \Pi_\perp C \right\rangle.$$

It obeys

$$\mu \partial_\mu \log(\Delta_C/\mu^2) = -2\Pi_\perp,$$

and hence has the certified scale response $(4\pi)^{-2}(199/30)\langle C, \Pi_\perp C \rangle$.

This quadratic-curvature functional is independent, at the declared order, within the class of operators sharing the same principal symbol, connection, self-adjoint domain, and source-complement prescription and differing at first curvature order only by a bundle endomorphism. Indeed, if $\Delta'_C = \Delta_C + V_1 + O(\mathcal{R}^2)$ with V_1 a self-adjoint curvature-order-one bundle endomorphism on the same domain, then

$$d \log(\Delta_C)[V_1] = \int_0^\infty (\Delta_C + s)^{-1} V_1 (\Delta_C + s)^{-1} ds.$$

Sandwiching this variation between two Weyl tensors has curvature order $1 + 1 + 1 = 3$. Thus the first missing completion data for this C^2 logarithmic carrier are cubic in the curvature [11, 12]. No independence under a change of bundle connection is claimed; such a change can introduce first-order differential terms not covered by V_1 . The independent nonlocal R^2 form factor, finite C^2 and absolute dressed $R(\hat{g})^2$ normalizations, cubic C^2 completion, kernel data and local-Weyl completion remain open.

Proposition 6.4 (Exact local $\square R$ scheme conversion). *In the zeta/proper-time prescription of Barvinsky et al. [7], the imported fourth heat-kernel rows combine with weights $(2, -1, -2)$ to give*

$$b_{\square}^{\text{raw}} = \frac{7}{2} \log \frac{3}{2} - \frac{159}{80} < 0.$$

The project convention

$$\omega \square R = -\frac{1}{12}s(R^2) \pmod{d}$$

therefore fixes the one-loop strict-metric counterterm

$$z_R^{\text{raw} \rightarrow 0} = \frac{b_{\square}^{\text{raw}}}{12} = \frac{7}{24} \log \frac{3}{2} - \frac{53}{320}.$$

It converts the raw coefficient to the repository $\square R = 0$ convention and, when added to the raw anomaly-induced local R^2 coefficient $391/960 - (7/24) \log(3/2)$, gives exactly $29/120$. This is a relative local one-loop scheme conversion. It neither computes the finite momentum- dependent R^2 form factor nor fixes the independent dressed $R(\hat{g})^2$ counterterm in the compensator theory, and it is not an all-loop equivalence theorem for strict Weyl gravity.

7 What does not follow

The strict obstruction and extended restoration are local one-loop results. They do not establish:

- an all-loop extended QME;
- a Lorentzian renormalized time-ordered product or Slavnov identity;
- a BRST-compatible global Hadamard state;
- positivity, a particle Hilbert space, scattering, or unitarity;
- survival or removal of either residual deformation class;
- a quantum Cartan identity or residual moment-map algebra.

Residual transfer is specifically forbidden at present. The frozen classical contraction belongs to the strict theory and has no compensator rows. The local Wess–Zumino contribution to Q_1 is fixed, but the proposition proves that it is not a unique complete renormalized operator. The anomaly-induced Paneitz/Riegert representative fixes one nonlocal solution, and the logarithmic conformal-sector coefficient is covariant and universal through curvature order two. The relative strict-metric raw-to- $\square R = 0$ R^2 scheme shift is now exact. The additive finite C^2 constant, absolute dressed $R(\hat{g})^2$ normalization, independent nonlocal R^2 form factor, cubic-and-higher C^2 completion, global Green/kernel data, and renormalized-product contribution remain open. The next gate is a compensator-inclusive classical contraction together with those missing data. The exact positive-Berger contraction does not fill this gate: its row named τ is a temporal diffeomorphism ghost on a different background, not the Wess–Zumino scalar compensator. The separate same-background free-state and Bridge 4 programme is outside this paper. Bridge 5 has a QME disposition but still lacks the independent interaction-to-physical-branch map. No classical tangent obstruction is therefore called ghost removal or a quantum constraint.

8 Machine certification and reproduction

The coefficient-bearing theorem receipts are

- `quantum-weyl/local_bv/certificates/MINIMAL_BV_KOSZUL_TATE_COLLAPSE.json`.

- quantum-weyl/local_bv/certificates/GENERAL_NONMINIMAL_GAUGE_FIXED_CONTRACTI
ON.json.
- quantum-weyl/spectral/euclidean/certificates/REPOSITORY_EUCLIDEAN_ELLIPTIC_
COMPLEX.json.
- quantum-weyl/spectral/euclidean/certificates/REPOSITORY_FULL_BV_MULTIPLICIT
Y_LEDGER.json.
- quantum-weyl/anomalies/certificates/REGULATED_REPOSITORY_BV_SLAVNOV_BREAKING.
json.
- quantum-weyl/anomalies/certificates/WESS_ZUMINO_EXTENDED_LOCAL_BV_COHOMOLOGY.
json.
- quantum-weyl/anomalies/certificates/WESS_ZUMINO_COMPENSATOR_EXTENSION_PREFI
GHT.json.
- quantum-weyl/transfer/certificates/ONE_LOOP_SLAVNOV_Q1_DISPOSITION.json.
- quantum-weyl/transfer/certificates/ANOMALY_INDUCED_NONLOCAL_GAMMA1.json.
- quantum-weyl/transfer/certificates/FLAT_TT_LOGARITHMIC_GAMMA1.json.
- quantum-weyl/transfer/certificates/CURVATURE_SQUARED_COVARIANT_LOG_GAMMA1.j
son.
- quantum-weyl/spectral/euclidean/certificates/WEYL_GRAVITON_BOX_R_SCHEME_CON
VERSION.json.

The cotangent-lift and matter-cone receipts are separate dependencies. The companion computa-
tional supplement prints the exact quotient ranks, orbit counts, coefficient vector, quartet matrices,
extended boundary matrix, and input-hash ledger from generated certificate tables. The claim map
binds the manuscript, both PDFs, the generated tables, their producer and verifier, and all explicit
nonclaims.

The scoped replay is:

```
PYTHONPATH=quantum-weyl python3 -m \
    anomalies.verify_wess_zumino_minimal_bv_cotangent_lift
PYTHONPATH=quantum-weyl python3 -m \
    anomalies.verify_wess_zumino_extended_local_bv_cohomology
PYTHONPATH=quantum-weyl python3 -m \
    transfer.verify_one_loop_slavnov_q1_disposition
PYTHONPATH=quantum-weyl python3 -m \
    transfer.verify_flat_tt_logarithmic_gamma1
PYTHONPATH=quantum-weyl python3 -m \
    transfer.verify_curvature_squared_covariant_log_gamma1
PYTHONPATH=quantum-weyl python3 -m \
    spectral.euclidean.verify_box_r_scheme_conversion
PYTHONPATH=quantum-weyl python3 -m verify_active_frontier
PYTHONPATH=quantum-weyl python3 -m atlas.verify_quantum_atlas_fragment
python3 paper/verify_12_pure_weyl_one_loop_bv_anomaly_claim_map.py
```

9 Outlook

The immediate local-to-residual question is now sharp. Supply the cubic and higher C^2 completion, independent nonlocal R^2 form factor, finite C^2 and absolute dressed $R(\widehat{g})^2$ normalization conditions and renormalized BV operator data to fix a complete Q_1 ; then, given an extended contraction $(\ell_{\text{ext}}, \pi_{\text{ext}}, S_{\text{ext}})$, compute

$$q_1 = \pi_{\text{ext}} Q_1 \ell_{\text{ext}}$$

and test first-order nilpotency, the quantum Cartan defect, incoming $H^3 \rightarrow H^4$, outgoing $H^4 \rightarrow H^5$, operator mixing, and the corrected pairing. This is a new theorem, not a corollary of local QME restoration.

The independent Lorentzian rail must construct renormalized causal products and a compatible state before any unitary or particle conclusion is possible. The present result nevertheless fixes the finite local obstruction vector that every such construction must reproduce or trivialize.

References

- [1] I. A. Batalin and G. A. Vilkovisky, *Gauge algebra and quantization*, Phys. Lett. B **102** (1981), 27–31.
- [2] M. Henneaux and C. Teitelboim, *Quantization of Gauge Systems*, Princeton University Press, 1992.
- [3] G. Barnich, F. Brandt, and M. Henneaux, *Local BRST cohomology in the antifield formalism. I. General theorems*, Commun. Math. Phys. **174** (1995), 57–91, [doi:10.1007/BF02099464](https://doi.org/10.1007/BF02099464).
- [4] N. Boulanger, *General solutions of the Wess–Zumino consistency condition for the Weyl anomalies*, J. High Energy Phys. **07** (2007), 069, [doi:10.1088/1126-6708/2007/07/069](https://doi.org/10.1088/1126-6708/2007/07/069).
- [5] E. S. Fradkin and A. A. Tseytlin, *Conformal anomaly in Weyl theory and anomaly free superconformal theories*, Phys. Lett. B **134** (1984), 187–193, [doi:10.1016/0370-2693\(84\)90668-3](https://doi.org/10.1016/0370-2693(84)90668-3).
- [6] F. Baume and B. Keren-Zur, *The dilaton Wess–Zumino action in higher dimensions*, J. High Energy Phys. **11** (2013), 102, [doi:10.1007/JHEP11\(2013\)102](https://doi.org/10.1007/JHEP11(2013)102).
- [7] A. O. Barvinsky, G. H. S. Camargo, A. E. Kalugin, N. Ohta, and I. L. Shapiro, *Local term in the anomaly-induced action of Weyl quantum gravity*, Phys. Rev. D **108** (2023), 086018, [doi:10.1103/PhysRevD.108.086018](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevD.108.086018).
- [8] R. J. Riegert, *A nonlocal action for the trace anomaly*, Phys. Lett. B **134** (1984), 56–60.
- [9] S. M. Paneitz, *A quartic conformally covariant differential operator for arbitrary pseudo-Riemannian manifolds*, SIGMA **4** (2008), 036, [doi:10.3842/SIGMA.2008.036](https://doi.org/10.3842/SIGMA.2008.036) (1983 manuscript).
- [10] A. O. Barvinsky and W. Wachowski, *Notes on conformal anomaly, nonlocal effective action and the metamorphosis of the running scale*, Phys. Rev. D **108** (2023), 045014, [doi:10.1103/PhysRevD.108.045014](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevD.108.045014).
- [11] A. O. Barvinsky, Yu. V. Gusev, V. V. Zhytnikov, and G. A. Vilkovisky, *Covariant perturbation theory (IV). Third order in the curvature*, arXiv:0911.1168.

- [12] J. F. Donoghue and B. K. El-Menoufi, *Covariant non-local action for massless QED and the curvature expansion*, J. High Energy Phys. **10** (2015), 044, [doi:10.1007/JHEP10\(2015\)044](https://doi.org/10.1007/JHEP10(2015)044).